even into oral cavity and causes pain in the centre of the chest due to the eroding nature of acidity (Figure.5.10).

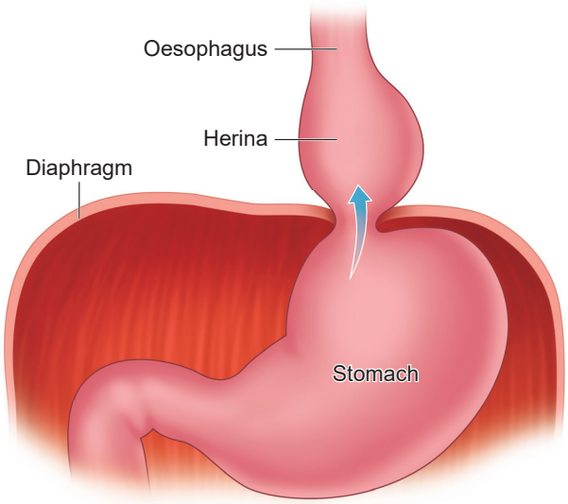


Figure 5.10 Hiatus hernia

Diarrhoea: It is the most common gastrointestinal disorder worldwide. It is sometimes caused by bacteria or viral infections through food or water. When the colon is infected, the lining of the intestine is damaged by the pathogens, thereby the colon is unable to absorb fluid. The abnormal frequency of bowel movement and increased liquidity of the faecal discharge is known as diarrhoea. Unless the condition is treated, dehydration can occur. Treatment is known as **oral hydration therapy**. This involves drinking plenty of fluids – sipping small amounts of water at a time to rehydrate the body.

Peptic ulcer: It refers to an eroded area of the tissue lining (mucosa) in the stomach or duodenum. Duodenal ulcer occurs in people in the age group of 25 - 45 years. Gastric ulcer is more common in persons above the age of 50 years. Ulcer is mostly due to infections caused by the bacterium ***Helicobacter pylori.*** It may also be caused due to uncontrolled usage of aspirin or certain antiinflammatory drugs. Ulcer may also be caused due to smoking, alcohol, caffeine and psychological stress.

Nobel Prize for the year 2005 was awarded to Robin Warren and Barry Marshall for the discovery of *Helicobacter pylori* which causes peptic ulcer**.**

Obesity: It is caused due to the storage of excess of body fat in adipose tissue. It may induce hypertension, atherosclerotic heart disease and diabetes. Obesity may be genetic or due to excess intake of food, endocrine and metabolic disorders. Degree of obesity is assessed by body mass index (**BMI**). A normal BMI range for adult is 19-25 above 25 is considered as obese. BMI is calculated as body weight in Kg, divided by the square of body height in meters. For example, a 50 Kg person with a height of 160 cms would have a BMI of 19.5.

That is BMI = $50 / (1.6)^2 = 19.5$



Food adulterants cause harmful effects in the form of headaches, palpitations, allergies, cancers and in addition reduces the quality of food. Common adulterants are addition of citric acid to lemon juice, papaya seeds to pepper, melamine to milk, vanillin for natural vanillin, red dyes to chillis, lead chromate and lead tetraoxide to turmeric powder, etc.,

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